

BIGARD MEMORIAL SEMINARY, ENUGU
(AFFILIATE OF UNIVERSITY OF IBADAN)
FACULTY OF ARTS
DEPARTMENT OF PHILOSOPHY
SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION 2023/2024 ACADEMIC SESSION

PHILOSOPHY THREE
PHI 313: - SOCIAL AND POLITICAL THOUGHT IN AFRICA

Instruction: Answer **Three** Questions Only.

Time Allowed: 3 HRS

1. In spite of popular cries and yearnings for freedom in Africa, its meaning in the African context is often elusive to many. Discuss. (20%)
2. Now, more than ever, it is supremely important for the African to understand clearly the character of what he is struggling for or against in his political aims and ideals if he hopes to achieve a healthy, stable, and self-reliant society. Discuss. (20%)
3. Today, best by myriads of economic problems and growing societal strife and insecurity, Africa seems to be in a political and developmental crises. Critically examine this statement. (20%)
4. Robert McNamara, a one-time President of the World Bank, observed in the mid-1990s that a consequence of years of political authoritarianism in Africa was that the region's countries face problems of governance far more severe than those of other regions. Discuss. (20%)
5. Historically, political violence in Africa has often been organised around tribal, ethnic, national and religious themes. Discuss. (20%)
6. Ujamaa or extended family-hood becomes for Julius Nyerere the foundation of the brand of African socialism which aims completely at human welfare and progress. Elaborate. (20%)

27 MAY 2024



UNIVERSITY OF IBADAN
DIRECTORATE OF AFFILIATED INSTITUTIONS
BIGARD MEMORIAL SEMINARY, ENUGU

Bmslib/3007

Candidate's Number (write very clearly)

300

Level of Study

ARTS

Faculty/College

PHILOSOPHY

Department/Course

social and political thought in Africa

PHI 313

Title of Paper

27 MAY 2024

Date

Examination (insert official title)
of the Examination for which you
have entered, as it appears at
the head of the question paper

DIRECTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Write on both sides of the pages (except in Mathematics)
2. Begin each answer on a fresh page
3. Write the number of each question at the top of each page.
4. All rough work must be crossed through, and enclosed within this cover.
5. If supplementary books are used, they must be fastened a; together at the end of this book and inside the cover. Answers must not be written on the supplementary books unless all the leaves in this book have already been used.
6. In your own interest you should enter in the space provided below, the numbers of the questions which you have attempted (with sub-sections where necessary).
7. In no circumstances must answer books used or unused, be removed from the Examination Room by a Candidate.
8. Candidates are warned that importance is attached by the examination to accuracy and clearness of expression.
9. Please note that there is severe penalty for cheating at any examination.

1, 5, 3

NUMBERS OF THE ANSWERS

in the order in which they have been written.

All students of the University of Ibadan are expected to show academic integrity at all times. Understanding this, I solemnly declare that I shall not be involved in any malpractice including soliciting, giving, receiving or using unauthorised aid in this examination.

[Signature]

Signature of student

For Examiner's
Use Only

Question
No.

Mark

1

18

5

18

3

18

CA

30

84

Total...

Africans before colonization have been in charge of the sectors of their economy and other areas of their affairs, not until the colonial master came and colonized. ^{then} Even after we have been declared independent we are still under their control. Hence, how can Africans be completely free.

Africans, especially Nigerians are economically, politically, socially diversified but poverty and underdevelopment is still the common denominator among us. It is a problem that calls for concern. In Nigeria for instance, we have many natural resources that could be so beneficial to the least of Nigerian citizen but we cannot even process our own mineral resources talk more ^{of} refining it. So, the concern of a Nigerian should be how to break away from such dilemma and pursue absolute and complete freedom.

We often make reference to "freedom from" and "freedom to". Freedom from entails being free from influence or external interference. Hence, we got that "freedom from" when we got our independence. However, are we "freedom to". Freedom to, depicts the fact that after gaining independence, we are ~~still~~ ^{not} completely ~~freedom~~ from external interference that is being free completely and not free but everywhere in chains. So, what is the cause of being free but are still controlled by external forces.

There are two basic factors that contribute to not being completely free, which are colonialism and Neo-colonialism.

Question.....

Colonialism was the period that the westerners colonised us, and was totally in charge of everything that concerned us and at a time our people fought for independence and eventually we gained independence. Despite gaining independence they used and are still using our "chiefs" to extort and exploit our economy and political affairs. Hence what is the way forward?

The complete freedom we are seeking can be achieved by breaking ^{away} from the ~~the~~ three (C^s) of a black man which includes (A) Civilization: They brought civilization and in turn took away that which is more important to us and are still in charge of us (B) Christianization and Islamization: Despite bringing Christianity to us, most of Africans especially Nigerians failed to learn the right Christianity to the extent that we don't know our right again in the name of religion (C) Colonialism: Despite being independent, they are still exploiting us and managing our resources indirectly.

Hence if we can break away from these three "C^s" of the black man, we are sure that we will be socially, psychologically, morally, religiously, economically and politically free.

Finally, Not mind the fact that the white men came and marginalised us and took away some of our treasure but there are many things that we can learn from them and not throw away everything completely. So, one should embrace quality education and other good things that they brought to us and make good use of it.

The major concerns for the leaders should be to protect the interest of the people. Hence, when the basic aim is not achieved then there is problem among those saddled with that responsibility. This however is the root of political violence.

Violence means the use of ^{force} ~~use~~ or coercion to enforce decision on people. On the other hand politics deals with process or affairs of the leader in allocating resources and power ^{that} are required. So political violence is the use of force in executing the affairs of ~~the~~ governance.

In Nigeria, there has been series of tribal, national, ethnic and religious theme that have caused a lot of harm to the citizens. The tribalism in Nigeria have cause a lot of havoc, for instance, that many Igbo are suffering today in some part of the Northern Nigeria is because they ~~to~~ presume that the Igbo are trying to dominate and take away everything. Likewise in Religious theme, many Christians have suffered a lot in the hands of Muslims for no just cost, many churches in the Northern part of this Nigeria has been burnt down ^{down} for the Muslims. Probably that they want to Islamise the country and dominate the country. Generally, there has been crises here and there, maybe because of selfish ambitions or the quest for fame and so on. But the most disappointing part of the whole thing is that the violence emanating from different parts of Nigeria and African in a whole has been more of disaster.

and underdevelopment. Hence, what are possible causes of this political violence.

Political violence in Nigeria and African in a whole have caused a whole lot of problem and some of the glaring problems or causes of the problems are corruption on the parts of the leaders, when the governance are weak and inability to act, also when the citizens refuses to participate in the electoral processes of the nation and finally, when there is bad leaders.

Everything that have causes must definitely have ways to remedy it. So, Political violence can be curbed by addressing corruption in the land and following it up with the required punishment as stipulated by the law, upholding the rule of Law, that is bringing to the consciousness of people the supremacy of the law over all, Strengthening a weak leaders ~~and~~ ^{by} caution and putting or electing a good leaders that can deliver etc.

The current issues that depicts political violence in Nigeria are The killing of people during election, by not being able to conduct simple election thereby upholding evil in the country, Burning of Christian churches and The recent killing of a Christian in the North by name Deborah etc.

finally, we can decide to uphold these remedies in order to curb political violence in African especially Nigeria because it is so detrimental to all the citizens of this country.

A country that have the economy that can feed their subject for decades but still lacks it is indeed a contradiction that calls for concern because Nigerians Likewise other African countries have a lot but still are unable to manage what they have.

Myriads of numerous natural economy, there has been problems or crises of underdevelopment and political crises and the whole issues are ~~depriving~~ ^{depriving} the progress of ~~Nigerians~~ ^{Africans} especially Nigerians.

The developmental crises or underdevelopment is majorly caused by inadequate infrastructure, in Nigeria, we have good road, food and many other good things, Even the little we have there are still lack of man power, that is trained persons to execute the job properly, The machines we have ^{not} can be enough to execute the job required hence, there is need for provision of quality machines that would be of great benefit to the masses and finally the government should always include or provide enough fund that should be proportionate to the required labour in order to enhance quality infrastructures in the land.

Another crises is political problem, that the leadership in Nigeria is not working well is because of the political crises. In Nigeria likewise other African countries, there is political apathy in the country where by the citizens refuse to elect those to protect their interest in government, another

Question.....

is the high rate of electoral malpractices ^{it's} quite unfortunate, take ^{for} instance, the malpractices that occurred in the last concluded election is nothing to write home about, another problem is the leaders not being accountable and transparent in discharging their duty thereby causing the citizens not to have hope in them. Another problem is bad leadership or weak governance, this is one of the factors that contribute to political crises, hence there should be leaders that ^{are} ready to work and protect the interests of the citizens.

We can solve this developmental and political crises by encouraging the masses to participate in election, and exposing the dangers of electoral malpractices to the root level otherwise the problem of malpractices will still be there and causing havoc in the country. On the other hand, government should have at hand the need to provide social amenities to the citizens. Their interest should be to ensure that there is good road, quality education, enough food and good machines that will be of help in producing good roads.

The economical, social strife and insecurity is the major factors that affects political and developmental problem. When a country cannot manage their economy, there is no way they can provide the necessary things required to the people and the social strife and insecurity have also contributed to hindering development and political crises.